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Some conservatives wary of campus tactics

Warn of long-term consequences spurred by Trump's slash-and-burn measures

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Under the Trump administration, conservatives in higher education appear to be on a winning streak.

Long feeling in the minority in higher education, free speech advocates and academics on the right have for years urged schools to broaden

their embrace of different political viewpoints and move away from left-leaning policies. And now, with Republicans firmly in control of the government, the Trump administration is trying to force schools to change by using tactics such as withholding billions in funding.

But while President Trump has unleashed his pressure campaign on

elite universities, some conservatives on campus are growing uncomfortable, not so much with the president's objectives, but with his slash-and-burn approach.

Nearly a dozen right-leaning policy experts, professors, and free speech advocates who support Trump's mission in interviews nonetheless criticized the administration for canceling funds appropriated by Congress for crucial research projects, often without notice or explanation. The administration's moves,

critics warn, could threaten universities' academic freedom, irreparably damage scientific progress, and set a precedent that could haunt conservatives if Democrats retake power.

"The essence of what he's doing has some merit to it, but the way he's done it has turned me into a critic," said Beth Akers, who studies higher education for the right-leaning American Enterprise Institute.

"The unfortunate side of his approach is that it's added political

CONSERVATIVES, Page A6

Exodus stymies bid to reshape '26 vote

Democrats leave Texas as GOP attempts to redraw congressional districts

By J. David Goodman and Grace Ashford,
NEW YORK TIMES

The gavel of a frustrated Texas House speaker fell on a truncated meeting of the legislative chamber Monday afternoon, as Democratic members who left the state Sunday to block passage of a redrawn US House district map appeared to be everywhere but in Austin, Texas.

Some of them were with Governor Kathy Hochul of New York as she vowed to match President Trump's push for aggressive partisan redistricting with a push of her own. Others were at a conference of state lawmakers in Boston, where Governor JB Pritzker of Illinois spoke to Democrats who chanted, "Fight! Fight!"

The largest number camped out in a secluded conference center outside of Chicago, appearing remotely for cable television and radio interviews and defying threats from Governor Greg Abbott of Texas and Republican state lawmakers back home. Texas Republicans could only fume that without a quorum present in the state House of Representatives, they could not do any legislative work, including a planned vote on a new map of the state's congressional districts that they hope will flip five

REDISTRICTING, Page A6

A Kraft pitch seeks cash, gets critics instead

Used unauthorized appeal from influential Democrats

By Emma Platoff
GLOBE STAFF

On first blush, the fund-raising solicitation sure looked like it was coming from US Senator Adam Schiff, the California Democrat well known for tangling with Donald Trump.

"Hi — this is Adam Schiff," the email read, according to a screenshot shared with the Globe. "Josh Kraft said I could reach out with this urgent message."

But the email came from "info@joshforboston.com" and it was paid for by the campaign of Josh Kraft, who is running for mayor of Boston, several thousand miles east of Schiff's district.

And, it turns out, Schiff never said Kraft could reach out with that urgent message.

The Kraft fund-raising email sporting Schiff's name and likeness is one of at least five the campaign has sent in recent weeks that feature promi-

KRAFT, Page A7

Boston officials released a draft of a sweeping plan to slash planet-warming emissions by the end of this decade. **B1.**

The verbal fist-cuffs between the US and Russia continued as the Kremlin warned against "nuclear rhetoric" after President Trump repositioned nuclear submarines. **A3.**

The Red Sox defeated the Royals 8-5 at Fenway Park after holding off a late Kansas City rally, giving Boston its sixth straight win. **C1.**



Cool for the city

Tuesday: Cooler. High 74-79, low 61-66.
Wednesday: Bit of sun, haze. High 74-79, low 60-65.
Sunrise: 5:41. Sunset: 7:59.
Weather and comics, **D5-6.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

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PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

The Atlantic Ocean is out there somewhere. At Nauset Beach, even the lifeguard has trouble finding it.

Sand castles, the pop-up kind

Massive tents, cabanas, inflatable sofas. Welcome to suburban sprawl by the sea.



The mobile beach home is a load for Brian Wood of Hampden, as he struggled across the soft sand of Nauset Beach.

By Beth Teitell
GLOBE STAFF

NAUSET BEACH

Remember when going to the beach was ... simple? You'd grab a couple of towels and maybe some chairs, although those were for mom and dad only.

But now? Call the decorator! All summer long I've been hearing about how elaborate beach setups have become. On the Cape. Martha's Vineyard. Old Orchard Beach.

Elaborate? I wondered. How? It's only the beach.

Last week I got my answer. I rose before the traffic, drove to Orleans, handed over \$32.50 to the parking attendant, trekked across the upper lot, and, finally, sweating, crested Nauset Beach.

But wait. The beach. Where was it? I scanned the vista, but there was no ocean. No sand. What was I even looking at? As far as the eye could see, there were only cabanas and tents and canopies and umbrellas, and more cabanas and tents and canopies and umbrellas, and more and more, until it all began to feel kind of depressing in a strange and colorful way, like suburban sprawl had finally reached its

CABANAS, Page A7

Schools' use of courts to stem truancy draws fire

By John Hilliard
GLOBE STAFF

Inside the courtroom at Framingham Juvenile Court, Karrie Conley felt her anxiety grow as a lawyer working for her daughter's junior high school outlined the truancy case against the girl.

The child, then 13, battled an autoimmune disease and illnesses including COVID, and her physician had diagnosed her as having a mental health crisis. As a result, the student had missed about two months' worth of school in the 2023-24 academic year, and was late for weeks more, according to school and medical records viewed by The Boston Globe.

In response, a vice principal at her junior high school in Acton-Boxborough's regional district petitioned the court to take the case. It's a tactic critics said is used by school districts across Massachusetts in recent years to clamp down on chronic absenteeism, which hit record levels during the pandemic.

From fiscal 2022 through 2025, schools asked the courts to intervene in truancy cases 5,400 times. In all, there



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

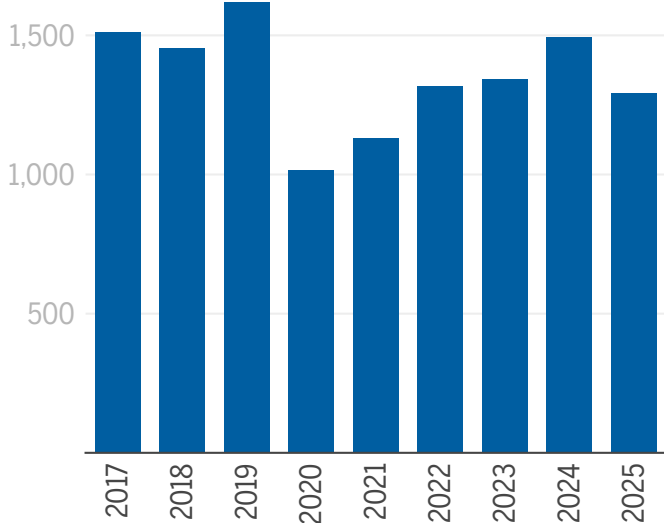
Karrie Conley said schools need to do more for kids with disabilities.

was a 13 percent increase in districts using the court process from the 2022 to 2024 fiscal years, according to a recent report from the state's Office of the Child Advocate. That report found inter-

TRUANCY, Page A10

More than 5,000 Massachusetts truancy filings since 2022

Schools and districts have made strides post pandemic, but advocates worry they are still taking too many students to court for truancy.



Tallies of cases are from the end of each academic year.

Chart: CHRISTOPHER HUFFAKER/GLOBE STAFF • Source: Massachusetts Trial Court